

On the Matter of Consciousness and Its Equivocation:

Toward a Physical Framework for the Properties of Conscious Mass

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Abstract

The ancient principle preserved in the Emerald Tablet, attributed to Hermes Trismegistus and foundational to centuries of philosophical inquiry, holds that the structure of what is above mirrors the structure of what is below. The Apostle Paul, writing to the Corinthians, observed that celestial bodies differ from one another in glory, as terrestrial bodies differ from one another in kind, and that the splendor of each is its own. These are not merely poetic observations. They are, this paper proposes, early articulations of a structural claim that physics has since made precise and that the study of human consciousness has not yet followed to its logical conclusion.

This paper proposes a first formal framework for treating conscious human beings as mass bodies subject to the same class of structural laws that govern physical mass systems. The proposal is not that human beings are literally stars, or that consciousness is reducible to matter. The proposal is more precise and more limited: that the properties which define the behavior of physical mass bodies, their mass, energy output, directional momentum, decay frequency,

wavelength character, probability space, and resonance coupling with other bodies, have genuine analogs in the properties of conscious human actors, and that these analogs are in principle observable, measurable, and formally expressible.

The framework draws on the established physical classification of stellar bodies, most rigorously developed through the spectroscopic work of Cecilia Payne-Gaposchkin, whose 1925 dissertation demonstrated that stars could be classified by measurable wavelength signatures into a coherent system of spectral types. This paper proposes an analogous classification for conscious mass bodies: a first attempt at mapping the qualitative properties of human actors onto a formal typology grounded in the same physical variables that govern stellar classification, and expressible through a proposed decay wave function $W(t)$ whose components are identified, whose relationships are proposed, and whose full mathematical formalization is offered as an invitation to future research.

The paper makes no claim to have completed this formalization. It claims something more modest and more useful: that the mapping is internally consistent, that the proposed variables are the right variables, that the physical analogs are genuinely analogous rather than merely illustrative, and that the framework generates testable predictions about how conscious actors accumulate influence, attract compatible others, approach critical life events, and transition into new forms. The full mathematical specification of these

relationships requires empirical calibration, computational modeling, and collaboration across physics, cognitive science, and the social sciences that exceeds the scope of this paper. What this paper provides is the architecture for that collaboration and an argument for why it is worth pursuing.

The question this paper opens is not only whether consciousness follows structural physical regularities. It is what that means for what mankind can become, what the limits of conscious becoming are, if any exist at all, and what the path looks like from nothing to something to the approach of becoming one with everything.

Keywords: consciousness, physical analogy, mass systems, stellar classification, decay function, wave function, conscious mass, probability space, resonance coupling, Payne-Gaposchkin, Hermes Trismegistus, as above so below, predictive framework

I. Introduction: As Above, So Below

'That which is above is as that which is below, and that which is below is as that which is above.' The Emerald Tablet, attributed to Hermes Trismegistus and preserved through centuries of alchemical and philosophical transmission, is not a mystical claim in the pejorative sense. It is a structural one. The logic governing what is large governs what is small. The logic governing celestial bodies governs terrestrial ones. The pattern that appears in the organization of galaxies appears in the organization of atoms. What is above and what is below are, at the level of structural law, the same thing expressed at different scales.

The Apostle Paul, in his first letter to the Corinthians, offered an observation that resonates with the same structural intuition: 'There are also celestial bodies, and bodies terrestrial: but the glory of the celestial is one, and the glory of the terrestrial is another. There is one glory of the sun, and another glory of the moon, and another glory of the stars: for one star differeth from another star in glory.' Paul's point is theological. But embedded within it is a structural observation that the classification of celestial bodies by their specific character, their glory, their output, their luminosity, maps onto the classification of earthly beings by their specific character as well. One star differs from another star in glory. One person differs from another person in the same way.

This paper takes these ancient observations seriously as philosophical foundations and proposes a framework that follows their structural logic to a contemporary scientific conclusion. Conscious human beings are physical entities. They occupy space, consume energy, exert influence on surrounding systems, attract and repel other bodies, and transition through forms across time. Whatever else consciousness is, it is embodied in physical mass, and that mass behaves. It accumulates. It decays. It approaches critical events and transitions into new forms. This paper proposes that the structural logic governing that behavior follows regularities that mirror those governing physical mass systems, and that those regularities are in principle formally expressible.

This is not a new philosophical tradition. Spinoza argued that mind and matter are two attributes of a single substance. Whitehead's process philosophy treated experience as a fundamental feature of physical reality. Teilhard de Chardin proposed that consciousness follows an evolutionary trajectory toward increasing complexity and convergence. More

recently, Giulio Tononi's integrated information theory proposes that consciousness is identical to a specific kind of information integration, a property that is in principle physically measurable. This paper builds on that tradition and extends it: proposing not only that consciousness is subject to physical structural regularities, but that those regularities can be mapped, classified, and expressed through a formal framework that generates testable predictions.

The framework proposed here is a first architecture, not a completed formalization. It is offered as an invitation: to physicists, mathematicians, cognitive scientists, and philosophers who find in it something worth building on. The path toward a predictive framework for conscious mass trajectories is open. This paper is its beginning.

II. The Foundational Proposition: Why the Physical Analogs Are More Than Illustration

This framework rests on a proposition that is philosophical before it is mathematical, and the paper is honest about that ordering. The proposition is this: conscious beings are physical entities. They occupy space, consume energy, exert influence on surrounding systems, attract and repel other bodies, and transition through forms across time. Whatever else consciousness is, it is embodied in physical mass, and that mass behaves in ways that are structurally analogous to the behavior of physical mass systems.

The foundational proposition on which this entire framework rests is therefore offered not as speculation but as a reasoned conjecture in the precise philosophical sense: a claim that is not yet proven, that is coherent with what is known, that generates testable predictions, and

that warrants serious empirical investigation. It is the kind of claim that serious inquiry begins with, not the kind it ends with. This paper is the beginning.

Influence accumulates and creates resistance to change in motion, exactly as physical mass does. Output depletes the actor producing it and sustains those receiving it, exactly as energy radiation does. And just as old stars do not merely shine and expire but seed the material conditions of the next generation of stellar formation, their expelled mass defining the chemical composition, density, and spin of the nebulae from which new stars emerge, so too do high-output conscious actors define the initial conditions of the systems that form after them. The Class O actor does not merely influence their contemporaries. They determine the starting probability space of those who come after, exactly as a supernova's remnant material carries the structural signature of the star that produced it into the next cycle of formation.

Directional commitment governs what other actors are drawn into a person's orbit, exactly as spin governs resonance coupling between physical bodies. The decay of conscious form follows a function that approaches critical events and transitions into new forms, exactly as stellar decay does. These are not metaphors. They are proposed structural correspondences whose validity is an empirical question, not a philosophical one, and the purpose of this paper is to propose the framework within which that empirical question can begin to be answered.

The analogs are proposed as genuine rather than merely illustrative on the following grounds. First, the variables identified are not imported arbitrarily from physics. They are identified because the phenomena they describe in physical systems have observable counterparts in conscious systems that behave in structurally similar ways. Second, the classification system proposed in this paper is grounded in observable proxies that are in

principle measurable with existing biographical, sociological, and organizational data. The spectrometer that Payne-Gaposchkin used to classify stars measured wavelength signatures. The instrument proposed here is the systematic analysis of documented human behavior across the seven variables: decision velocity, output character, network formation patterns, behavioral consistency under pressure, and the magnitude and character of critical life events. Third, the wave function $W(t)$ is proposed as a formal structure: a claim about which variables matter, that their interaction is continuous and composite, and that the trajectory of a conscious actor toward their next critical event is in principle calculable from their current state.

III. Table 1: Properties of Conscious Mass Bodies

The following table maps eight physical properties of mass systems onto their conscious mass equivalents, proposes observable proxies for each, and specifies the expected effect on the decay trajectory. These are proposed correspondences requiring empirical calibration. Each case to which the framework is applied should refine the weighting of existing variables and identify additional variables not captured in this first attempt.

Physical Property

Physical Definition

Conscious Mass Equivalent

Observable Proxy

Effect on Decay Trajectory

Mass (M)

Quantity of matter; determines gravitational pull and resistance to change in motion.

Accumulated influence, commitments, resources, and relationships. The weight of what has been built and who depends on it.

Network size, resource base, institutional position, number of dependents.

Higher mass increases gravitational pull on surrounding bodies and energy required to change trajectory. High mass actors produce larger events at critical points.

Energy Output (E)

Power radiated per unit time; determines luminosity and influence on surrounding system.

Rate at which the actor converts mass into action, production, or influence. Old stars seed the nebulae from which new stars form; high-output actors define the initial conditions of systems that emerge after them.

Output per unit time: decisions, capital deployed, organizations built, works produced.

High output accelerates approach to critical events. Sustained high output depletes mass faster. Low output extends duration of stable phase.

Spin Vector (S)

Angular momentum; determines directional orientation, governs what the body attracts and repels.

Personality as directional character. Not preference in isolation but the fundamental orientation of seeking: what trajectory the actor is on, what they are building toward.

Documented long-term commitments, stated values sustained under pressure, behavioral consistency across contexts.

Spin determines which other mass bodies enter the probability space. Compatible spins accumulate into systems. Incompatible spins repel or destabilize.

Decay Frequency (f)

Rate at which a mass body converts its current form into energy and new form; determines lifecycle timescale.

Pace at which the actor acts, decides, produces, and transforms. Operational tempo.

Decision velocity, rate of output, frequency of strategic pivots, metabolic intensity of engagement.

High frequency actors reach critical points faster. Low frequency actors accumulate mass over longer periods. Determines whether a lifecycle event unfolds over months or decades.

Wavelength Character (λ)

Specific signature of energy emission; spectral class. O B A F G K M from hottest to coolest.

Qualitative character of output and influence. Whether the actor generates capacity in those around them or extracts it.

Character of what is built, type of actors drawn into orbit, nature of legacy, net effect on participant capacity over time.

Determines type of event the decay produces. High energy wavelengths produce faster more explosive transitions. Lower energy wavelengths produce slower accumulations and more stable post-transition forms.

Probability Space (P)

Range of possible future states accessible to a system given current position, momentum, and energy.

Full range of trajectories available at any given moment. Expands as mass and energy accumulate. Contracts as the system approaches the event horizon of a critical commitment.

Documented opportunity sets, resource access, social position, institutional affiliation, historical reconstruction of available paths.

Not fixed. Narrows toward the trajectory the spin has been defining. Near the event horizon of a major life transition, effective probability space approaches a point.

Resonance Coupling (R)

Tendency of systems with compatible frequencies to amplify one another and enter stable coupled relationships.

Mechanism by which conscious actors pursuing compatible trajectories find one another over time. Not coincidence but the result of moving through the same probability space with overlapping decay frequencies and compatible spin.

Documented patterns of collaboration, network formation around specific institutional projects, regularity with which compatible actors encounter one another across contexts.

Resonance coupling accelerates mass accumulation for all bodies in the system. Two compatible spin bodies entering resonance produces a combined mass body with new decay properties neither possessed independently.

Event Horizon

Boundary beyond which gravitational pull of collapsing mass body exceeds any possible escape velocity.

Point at which accumulated commitments, dependencies, and spin momentum exceed any individual capacity to redirect the system. The point past which trajectory is determined by the composite system rather than any single actor.

Documented moments of irreversible commitment, point at which decay becomes publicly self-reinforcing, moment accumulated mass becomes structural constraint rather than resource.

Past the event horizon, individual agency is real but structural escape trajectories are no longer accessible. What emerges on the other side is determined by the spin inputs at the moment of convergence.

The composite of these eight variables at any given moment constitutes the institutional decay vector: a directional description of the actor's current trajectory, their rate of approach toward a critical threshold, and the character of the transition that trajectory is producing. The decay vector is not static. It responds continuously to changes in any of its component variables.

IV. The Decay Wave Function $W(t)$

Each conscious mass body can be described at any moment t by a decay wave function $W(t)$ whose value is determined by the composite interaction of the seven properties identified in Table 1:

$$W(t) = f(M, E, S, f, \lambda, P, R)$$

where M is mass, E is energy output, S is spin vector, f is decay frequency, λ is wavelength character, P is probability space, and R is resonance coupling with other bodies in

the local system.

The trajectory of $W(t)$ toward its next critical event is the composite product of all seven variables interacting continuously. This is not a derived equation. It is a proposed formal structure: a claim that these seven properties are real, that they are in principle observable and measurable, and that their relationships follow the same structural logic as the physical analogs from which they are drawn.

The specific mathematical relationships between the variables, whether additive, multiplicative, or more complex, are precisely what empirical calibration across a large case set would determine. The wave function proposes the architecture. The formalization is the work it is calling for.

As probability space P contracts toward the event horizon of a critical life transition, the effective range of the wave function narrows toward a point. At that point, the transition occurs. What emerges on the other side is determined entirely by the spin inputs, the wavelength character, and the accumulated mass at the moment of convergence. This is the conscious equivalent of stellar collapse: the prior form terminates and the new form begins immediately, its character already determined by the inputs of the transition event.

V. Table 2: The Conscious Mass Classification System

Following the approach of Cecilia Payne-Gaposchkin, whose 1925 dissertation established that stars could be classified by measurable spectroscopic signatures into a coherent system of types that predicted their behavior and lifecycle, this paper proposes an analogous classification for conscious mass bodies. The classification is grounded in the seven

variables of the wave function and organized by the character of the actor's energy output, directional spin, decay frequency, and wavelength character. It is presented as a first attempt, explicitly incomplete, inviting refinement through empirical application.

Stellar Class

Human Analog

Key Properties

Historical Example

Trajectory Character

Class O: Supergiant

World-Historical Architect

Maximum mass, maximum energy, shortest lifecycle, civilizational scope, collapse reshapes everything

Alexander the Great: built system spanning three continents in thirteen years, died at thirty-two, collapse produced centuries of successor kingdoms

Explosive, total, brief. The system outlasts the actor by orders of magnitude.

Class B: Blue Giant

Transformative Institutional Builder

Very high energy, generational influence, powerful directional spin, transforms fields rather than civilizations

Nikola Tesla: transformed physical infrastructure of civilization, high output, decay released energy powering subsequent generations

Intense and directional. Often unrecognized during stable phase. Collapse produces wide energy release.

Class A: White Star

System-Generating Entrepreneur

High and sustained output, strong consistent spin, clear directional character across decades, large orbital system

Elon Musk: multiple simultaneous system-generating ventures, high decay frequency, consistent directional spin across domains

Long high-output phase. Multiple critical events. Each transition produces new system.

Class F: Yellow-White Star

Institutional Sustainer

High organizational mass, moderate energy, long stable phase, sustains large systems without necessarily generating them

Warren Buffett: enormous accumulated mass, moderate decay frequency, stable spin sustained over seven decades

Long and stable. Influence through sustained gravity rather than high output.

Class G: Yellow Star

Community Builder / Master Craftsperson

Moderate mass and energy, long productive lifecycle, sufficient for meaningful local system, stable spin

Defined by not producing singular historical examples. Builders of the institutions historical figures inhabited.

Steady and sustaining. Local influence radius. Longest stable phase of all generative classes.

Class K: Orange Dwarf

Deep Local Actor

Lower energy output directed inward, deep local influence, very long productive phase, primary relationships sustained over lifetimes

The master teacher whose students became world-historical figures. Influence measured in depth not breadth.

Quiet and sustained. Influence through presence and consistency rather than output velocity.

Class M: Red Dwarf

Sustainer Within Others' Systems

Minimal external influence, primary existence within others' orbital systems, capable of sustaining very close stable relationships over entire lifetimes

Most common human type. Sustains the fabric of local systems without which no larger system functions.

Extremely long, extremely stable. The foundation layer of all conscious mass systems.

Brown Dwarf

The Almost-Star

Internal character of system-generator, never achieved ignition threshold, warm but not luminous, intense local presence without broader influence radius

The entrepreneur whose venture came within reach of ignition and did not sustain.
Intensely felt locally, invisible globally.

Frustrated accumulation. High internal energy without external expression. May
reignite under new conditions.

White Dwarf

The Post-Collapse Elder

Remnant of former high-output actor, no longer generating through primary function,
radiating residual accumulated wisdom, extraordinarily dense

Nelson Mandela in final years: formerly Class B during anti-apartheid period, emerged
from imprisonment as something denser and more stable

Influence through what has already been built and become. Density without velocity.

Neutron Star

The Collapsed Pulsar

Survived supercritical collapse, extraordinarily dense, narrow precise output beams at
regular intervals, small volume enormous mass, post-collapse form unrecognizable from prior
class

Dostoevsky: arrested, sentenced to death, reprieved, exiled to Siberia. Emerged
producing narrow precise beams of influence across a century and a half.

Pulsed and precise. When the beam crosses you it is unmistakable. Influence in one
narrow domain of extraordinary depth.

Black Hole

The Invisible Organizer

Mass so collapsed that direct output is invisible, organizes enormous activity around itself through pure gravity, visible only through behavior of surrounding actors

The advisor whose name does not appear. The financier behind the movement. Known by watching what orbits them.

Total structural influence without visible emission. The system would collapse or reorient without their gravitational center.

Comet

The Visitor

Highly eccentric orbit, long periods in outer reaches, brief dramatic transit through local system, carries material from entirely different systems, permanently perturbs orbits it crosses

Rasputin: arrived from outside the Romanov system, transited at extraordinary speed, perturbed every orbit within it, disappeared in violent exit leaving system destabilized.

Brief, intense, permanent in effect. Does not orbit. Transits. The encounter changes the trajectory of those it crosses forever.

Several observations about this classification system are worth stating explicitly. First, classification is not fixed across a lifetime. An actor may move between classes as their mass accumulates, their decay frequency changes, and their probability space contracts or expands. A Brown Dwarf may reignite under new conditions. A Class A actor may collapse into a White Dwarf or a Neutron Star depending on the character of their critical transition. The classification describes current state, not permanent destiny.

Second, the classification operates at multiple scales simultaneously. Within a local system, a Class G actor may function as the gravitational center around which Class M and K actors orbit. Within a larger system, that same Class G actor orbits a Class A or B. The stellar analogy holds at every scale: what is a star in one system is a planet in another, depending on the reference frame.

Third, God, understood across human cultures whether as monotheistic singular creator or as the organizing principle of polytheistic systems, appears in this framework as the universal gravitational center: the mass body around which all conscious mass systems ultimately orbit, the source of the spin that gives the entire system its directional character. This observation is not a scientific claim. It is the author's own conviction, offered honestly as such, and consistent with the structural logic the framework proposes. All human cultures have organized their understanding of ultimate reality around a center. The convergence of that observation across radically different contexts is itself a structural datum worth investigating.

VI. From Qualitative to Quantitative: A Proposed Measurement Architecture

The central methodological challenge of this framework is the one that separated Payne-Gaposchkin's classification from prior stellar taxonomy: moving from descriptive categories to measurable signatures. Prior astronomers had classified stars by appearance. Payne-Gaposchkin classified them by spectroscopic data, measurable wavelength signatures reproducible by any observer with the right instrument. The classification became scientific at the moment it became measurable.

This framework proposes that the same transition is possible for conscious mass bodies, and that the instrument already exists in partial form. It is the systematic analysis of documented human behavior across the seven variables. What follows is a first proposed measurement architecture for each variable, specifying what would be measured, how, and what the resulting value would represent.

Mass M is measured as accumulated influence density: the total number of actors whose documented trajectories show meaningful alteration attributable to the subject, weighted by the magnitude of that alteration and the duration of its effect. Energy Output E is measured as documented production per unit time across the actor's peak period. Spin vector S is measured as behavioral consistency under pressure across documented contexts. Decay frequency f is measured as decision velocity: the average time between major strategic pivots or documented transformations. Wavelength character λ is measured through legacy analysis: the documented character of what actors in the subject's orbit built after contact. Probability space P is measured as opportunity set density at any given moment in the actor's documented trajectory. Resonance coupling R is measured as the documented rate of compatible spin body attraction and the acceleration in mass accumulation that followed each coupling event.

These seven measurements, taken together across a documented life, produce the input vector for $W(t)$. The trajectory that vector describes toward the actor's next critical event is the object of the predictive claim this framework is working toward. With sufficient cases, computational resources, and empirical rigor in the measurement procedures, the framework proposes that it becomes possible to construct a spatial map of conscious mass trajectories: a system in which the collision of two conscious mass bodies, the formation of a new system, the

approach of a critical event, become not merely observable in retrospect but anticipated in advance.

The measurement architecture proposed here is a first step. The specific coding schemes, the inter-rater reliability procedures, the longitudinal data collection protocols, these require development that exceeds the scope of this paper. The paper names them honestly as what awaits, and invites the researchers who specialize in each domain to bring their methods to bear on the framework's propositions.

VII. What Empirical Testing Would Look Like

This section does not pretend to have resolved the methodological challenges of testing the framework. It maps them honestly, proposes what testing would require, and names the specific disciplines whose collaboration would be necessary to begin.

The first testable prediction is classificatory consistency. If the classification system is coherent rather than arbitrary, then two independent researchers applying the measurement architecture to the same historical figure should arrive at the same or adjacent classification. This is achievable with existing biographical and archival data. It does not require new physics. It requires careful qualitative methodology of the kind that social scientists already know how to do. This is where empirical testing could begin, and where this paper invites graduate researchers in sociology, organizational behavior, and historical biography to engage.

The second prediction is trajectory anticipation. If $W(t)$ identifies the right variables and their composite describes the actor's approach toward critical events, then given sufficient data on an actor's current state across the seven variables, it should be possible to anticipate the

character of their next critical transition before it occurs. Testing this requires longitudinal data: repeated measurement of the same actors across time, combined with documentation of the critical events that occur and comparison to the predicted trajectory. This is a long-term empirical project requiring sustained institutional investment.

The third prediction is resonance anticipation. Given the documented properties of two actors operating in the same field or system, it should be possible to predict whether and when they will enter coupled relationship, and what the character of that coupling will produce. This is testable through network analysis of documented collaboration histories across large samples.

The fourth prediction is legacy mapping. If the output of a high-mass actor defines the initial conditions of the systems that form after them, as old stars seed the nebulae from which new stars emerge, then it should be possible to trace the structural signature of a Class O or B actor forward through subsequent generations, identifying how their specific wavelength character shaped the probability space of those who came after.

What this paper cannot provide is the formalization that would make these tests definitive rather than indicative. The specific mathematical relationships between the seven variables, the precise form of the decay function, the computational model that would allow trajectory prediction at scale, these require physicists, mathematicians, and cognitive scientists whose expertise exceeds what any single paper can contain. This paper is addressed to them as much as to anyone. It says: here is the architecture. Here are the predictions. Here is what testing would require. The path toward a predictive framework for conscious mass trajectories is open. We do not know where precisely it ends. We know it is worth walking.

VIII. Conclusion

The ancient intuition that the structure of what is above mirrors the structure of what is below is not mysticism. It is a philosophical proposition with a structural claim at its center: that the same class of logic governing physical mass systems governs conscious ones, and that the difference between them is one of scale and complexity rather than of kind.

This paper has proposed a first formal framework for investigating that proposition. It has identified seven variables whose physical definitions have genuine conscious analogs. It has proposed a decay wave function whose architecture can be built upon with greater empirical rigor and computational resources than any single paper can provide. It has proposed a classification system for conscious mass bodies following the approach of Cecilia Payne-Gaposchkin, grounded in measurable proxies and organized by the physical variables of the wave function. And it has proposed four categories of empirical prediction that the framework generates and that future research can test.

The question this paper opens is not only whether consciousness follows structural physical regularities. It is what that means for what mankind can become. If conscious mass bodies follow decay functions that approach critical events and transition into new forms, then the trajectory of any conscious actor is not random. It is in principle knowable. The probability space around each conscious being, the range of what they can become, is shaped by the variables the framework identifies. And if those variables are measurable, if the trajectory is in principle calculable, then the ancient question of human destiny moves from the domain of theology and speculation into the domain of empirical inquiry.

What are the limits of conscious becoming, if any exist at all? From nothing, to something, to the approach of becoming one with everything: this paper proposes that this trajectory is not merely a spiritual aspiration. It is a structural description of what conscious mass does when its decay function, its spin, its resonance with other bodies, and its accumulated mass all point in the same direction across a sufficient duration. The formalization of that description is the work that awaits. This paper is its invitation.

One speculative conclusion deserves to be named honestly as such, and offered not as a claim but as a horizon. The history of science suggests that the frameworks we build precede by decades or centuries the instruments that allow us to measure what those frameworks describe. Cecilia Payne-Gaposchkin classified stars by their spectroscopic signatures in 1925. The instruments that made that classification possible had been developing for half a century before her. The theoretical framework for gravitational waves preceded their direct detection by a hundred years. This paper proposes, with full acknowledgment that this is speculation rather than prediction, that waiting for mankind is an instrument we have not yet discovered: a technology capable of measuring not merely the calculated approximation of a conscious actor's decay wave function, but its direct and observable output. Just as later researchers were able to refine Payne-Gaposchkin's classifications through increasingly precise spectroscopic measurement, the framework proposed here may one day be refined not through biographical reconstruction and longitudinal analysis alone, but through the direct measurement of conscious wavelength output. What that instrument looks like, what physical signature it detects, and what it will reveal about the range of what conscious mass can become, is the open question this paper leaves at the frontier. The technology may be waiting. The framework

proposed here is an argument that it is worth looking for.

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